

INTEREST AND SKILL SELF-ASSESSMENT # 45

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Assess my personal interests and abilities and identify ways to apply existing personal skills in my work.
2. Plan ways to bring more meaning and fulfillment to my work life.
3. Identify relapse risk factors in my work and plan strategies to cope with them.

ADDITIONAL HOMEWORK THAT CAN BE APPLICABLE TO CLIENTS WHO EXPERIENCE OCCUPATIONAL PROBLEMS

- Balancing Recovery, Family, and Work
- Barriers and Solutions
- Communication Skills
- Consequences of Continuing Addictive Lifestyles
- Identifying Conflict Themes
- Negotiating Skills for Success
- Understanding My Defense Mechanisms
- What Price Am I Willing to Pay?
- What's Addiction Got to Do with My Problems?

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

The “Interest and Skill Self-Assessment” activity is designed to help clients gain clarity about their interests and priorities and identify things they do well. It provides encouragement to explore new ways to apply interests and skills in occupational pursuits. It directs the client through an interest self-assessment, a skill self-assessment, a recovery assessment, and a plan for implementing changes to his/her existing work situation or choosing what he/she may pursue in the future. It may be helpful for clients to visualize what their work lives would look like if they were truly fulfilling their lives’ purposes. If the new insights lead them to decide to change their existing jobs or careers, it might be useful and helpful to have them work with career counselors.

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If you feel unsatisfied with your current occupation, feel the need to change your work environment because it puts your recovery at risk, or have lost your job, it may help to analyze where your interests lie and what you do well before you decide what to do about your future employment. When you do something you enjoy and are good at, it improves the quality of your life. It's also vital to choose work that supports your recovery, or at least doesn't interfere with it. This exercise will guide you in determining your own interests and skills.

Interests Self-Assessment

1. Does the work you're doing in your current job interest you? If so, what about it do you like? If not, what would you rather be doing?

2. What work would you choose if you could do what you truly wanted? (For the purpose of this exercise, eliminate money/family/other responsibilities as factors.)

3. Of the following items, circle those that give your life the greatest meaning.

Satisfaction with family life

Friendship

Good health

Spiritual awareness

Helping others

Intimacy with others

Material success

Educational achievement

Creative outlet/expression

Personal growth/awareness

Career advancement

Integrity

Other: _____

Skill Self-Assessment

4. What are your strongest skills or abilities?

5. Do you use them in your current job? If so, how?

6. If not, what work or employment would let you put those skills or qualities to good use?

7. What's the most important thing for you in choosing a profession and enjoying it (e.g. interest, skill, items in question 3)?

Recovery Assessment

8. In what ways is your recovery supported by your current work environment, coworkers, work schedule, and so on?

9. How does your current work environment put your recovery in jeopardy (e.g., addictive actions encouraged, stressful work conditions, prevents meeting attendance)?

Putting-It-All-Together Plan

10. In reviewing your answers to the previous questions, what parts of your current work situation are acceptable, and what are the things that you would like to change?

11. What are you willing to do to work toward implementing these changes in the next month? The next year?

The next month:

The next year:
